

Stuffed Cabbage Soup

Like stuffed cabbage? You'll love this easy cabbage soup. It's got all of the classic flavors of stuffed cabbage without all the fuss of stuffing.

By **Karen Rankin** | Updated on September 17, 2025

 Reviewed by Dietitian **Christa Brown, M.S., RDN, LD**

Prep Time: 20 mins

Additional Time: 40 mins

Total Time: 1 hr

Servings: 8

Yield: 8 servings

Nutrition Profile:

Nut-Free Dairy-Free Soy-Free High-Protein Egg-Free Gluten-Free

Ingredients

2 tablespoons neutral oil, such as canola or avocado

1 ½ pounds lean ground beef

4 cups chopped green cabbage

2 cups chopped yellow onion

1 ¼ cups chopped carrots

1 cup chopped celery

2 tablespoons light brown sugar

1 tablespoon smoked paprika

1 teaspoon salt

½ teaspoon ground pepper

¼ teaspoon cayenne pepper

1 (15 ounce) can no-salt-added tomato sauce

4 cups unsalted chicken broth

¼ cup medium-grain brown rice

2 tablespoons chopped fresh flat-leaf parsley (optional)

Directions

Step 1

Heat oil in a large heavy pot over medium-high heat. Add ground beef; cook, stirring often, until the meat is cooked through and starting to brown slightly, 6 to 7 minutes. Add cabbage, onion, carrots and celery; cook, stirring often, until the onion is translucent, about 5 minutes.

Step 2

Add brown sugar, paprika, salt, pepper and cayenne to the beef mixture; cook over medium-high heat, stirring constantly, until the spices are toasted, about 1 minute. Stir in tomato sauce and broth, scraping the bottom of the pot with a wooden spoon to release any browned bits. Bring the soup to a boil over medium-high heat. Stir in rice. Reduce heat to low; cover and cook until the rice is tender, 30 to 35 minutes. If desired, sprinkle with parsley before serving.

Equipment

Large pot

Frequently Asked Questions

What type of cabbage should I use for Stuffed Cabbage Soup?

We use green cabbage for this soup, which is the most common variety of cabbage. Green cabbage is a cruciferous vegetable that's versatile and inexpensive and has a mild flavor. A head of green cabbage is round and compact, with tightly packed smooth leaves. Feel free to mix other types of cabbage into the soup, like napa cabbage or Savoy cabbage, for some variety.

Can I use regular paprika instead of smoked paprika?

Yes, you can use regular paprika instead of smoked paprika, but it will give the soup a different flavor profile. Smoked paprika has an earthy, smoky flavor, while regular paprika is mild and sweet.

Can I make Stuffed Cabbage Soup ahead?

Yes, you can make the soup ahead! Refrigerate in an airtight container for up to 5 days or freeze for up to 3 months.

What should I serve with Stuffed Cabbage Soup?

Soup with a salad or sandwich is a classic pairing that always works. Serve this soup with a simple grilled cheese sandwich or try it with our Sweet Potato Grilled Cheese Sandwich. If you want

something quick and easy, choose a prepackaged salad or whip up our Mixed Lettuce Salad with Cucumber Herb Vinaigrette.

Nutrition Facts

Per serving: **Serving Size 1 1/2 cups** 300 calories; total fat 17g; saturated fat 5g; cholesterol 58mg; sodium 434mg; total carbohydrate 18g; dietary fiber 3g; total sugars 7g; added sugars 3g; protein 20g; vitamin c 22mg; calcium 56mg; iron 3mg; potassium 695mg

Additional reporting by Carrie Myers, M.S., Jan Valdez, and Sara Haas, RDN, LDN

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